## Jameel

Jameel and Farooq sat in front of me in my office. I really did not know what to make of these two Kashmiri men. Jameel, a short athletic type with a well-trimmed beard, and Farooq, lanky, with an unkempt beard and a cunning look in his eye. Jameel, a little taciturn; Farooq the more loquacious. This, I was to learn later, was only because Jameel could not speak Hindi as fluently as his friend. Neither were Jameel and Farooq their real names. These were their aliases adopted while working as informers for the Army. These identities were so deeply ingrained that even their family members and friends called them by these names. Even their mothers called them thus.

But that cloudy day, only a few days after I had assumed command of 2 RR, they had something important to tell me. I still could not figure them out, much less make head or tail of what they were trying to say. I called for my Adjutant and asked him to clarify. Jameel elaborated, which was translated by Farooq.

'There is a group of terrorists in village Lawepura,' said Farooq, with that cunning look of his coming to the fore.

'How do you know?' asked Maj Rehan Durrani, my Adjutant. Another flurry of questions and answers ensued between Jameel and Farooq, before the latter replied.

'Jameel's mother's sister lives in that village,' said Farooq. 'She had gone to visit her and her sister told her.'

'So, the terrorists are in Jameel's aunt's house, right?' I intervened.

'No. Actually, the aunt had gone to visit another friend who is sick; she saw the terrorists in that friend's house. When she came back, she told Jameel's mother, who on returning home told Jameel,'—who told us, I said to myself.

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